

Service Reception SOP

Syed Motors · Document Code: SOP-02 · Type: sop · Department: Service

Purpose

How the service advisor receives a customer's vehicle, opens a job-card, and communicates with the customer through the repair cycle.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Vehicle Handover

On arrival, the service advisor conducts a walk-around with the customer, notes existing dents/scratches on the diagram sheet, checks fuel level, mileage, and any personal items in the vehicle. The customer signs the walk-around sheet before the vehicle is accepted.

The walk-around establishes the vehicle's condition at the time of reception. The advisor should carry out the inspection with the customer so that existing exterior marks and the listed vehicle information are identified before the vehicle enters the repair cycle.

The fuel level, mileage, and personal items form part of the reception record. Recording these details at handover provides a reference for the vehicle's condition and contents when it is received by the Service department.

The customer's signature on the walk-around sheet is required before the vehicle is accepted. This makes the signed walk-around sheet an important part of the handover stage.

2. Job Card

The advisor opens a job card in the DMS with the customer complaint in the customer's own words, adds the technician diagnosis notes separately, records estimated cost and estimated ready-time, and secures the customer's signature and confirmed contact number.

The job card separates the customer's reported complaint from the technician's diagnosis. This distinction keeps the original customer concern identifiable while allowing technical findings to be recorded separately.

The estimated cost and estimated ready-time give the customer a reference for the expected repair. The customer's signature and confirmed contact number complete the required job-card information before the repair cycle proceeds.

1. Vehicle Handover - Reception Procedure

The vehicle handover is the first operational stage of the service reception process. The service advisor and customer jointly establish the vehicle's condition before acceptance.

Walk-around. The advisor conducts a walk-around with the customer on arrival. The inspection is performed before the vehicle is accepted by the Service department.

Existing damage. Existing dents and scratches are noted on the diagram sheet. The purpose of this record is to capture the vehicle condition observed at reception.

Fuel and mileage. The advisor checks the vehicle's fuel level and mileage and includes these observations in the reception process.

Personal items. Personal items in the vehicle are checked during the handover. This forms part of the condition and contents review performed with the customer.

Customer sign-off. The customer signs the walk-around sheet before the vehicle is accepted. The sign-off marks completion of the vehicle handover stage.

Reception Record

The handover information creates the starting point for the repair cycle. The walk-around sheet records the condition identified at reception, while the later job card records the complaint and repair-related information.

Keeping these stages distinct helps the advisor maintain a clear record of what was observed at handover and what work was subsequently requested or identified.

2. Job Card - Information Structure

The job card is opened in the DMS and contains several distinct pieces of information. The customer's complaint is recorded in the customer's own words. Technician diagnosis notes are added separately. Estimated cost and estimated ready-time are recorded, followed by the customer's signature and confirmed contact number.

2. Job Card - Repair Cycle Record

The job card provides the working record for the service visit. Its structure allows the customer's original concern, technical diagnosis, expected cost, expected completion timing, and customer contact information to be kept together.

Customer complaint. The customer's complaint is recorded in the customer's own words. This preserves the original description rather than replacing it with an interpretation made during reception.

Technician diagnosis. Technician diagnosis notes are recorded separately from the customer's complaint. This allows the technical findings to be distinguished from the customer's initial description.

Estimated cost. The advisor records the estimated cost as part of opening the job card. This provides the initial cost reference for the repair cycle.

Estimated ready-time. The advisor records the estimated ready-time so the customer has an expected completion reference.

Signature and contact number. The customer's signature and confirmed contact number are secured as part of the job-card process.

3. Estimate Approval

If additional work is identified during diagnosis and the additional cost exceeds 10 percent of the estimate, the advisor must obtain the customer's approval by call or WhatsApp before proceeding. The approval must be recorded in the job card.

This requirement applies when diagnosis identifies additional work and the additional cost exceeds 10 percent of the estimate. The advisor must obtain customer approval before proceeding with that additional work.

Approval may be obtained by call or WhatsApp, and the approval must then be recorded in the job card. The communication channel and the job-card record together establish the required approval trail.

Communication During Additional Work

The estimate approval step connects technical diagnosis with customer communication. When additional work changes the expected cost beyond the stated threshold, the customer is brought back into the decision before the additional work proceeds.

4. Delivery - Completion of the Service Cycle

At delivery, the advisor walks the customer through the invoice line-by-line, hands over old parts unless they are returned to OEM under warranty, and completes a post-service satisfaction call within 48 hours.

Invoice walkthrough. The advisor reviews the invoice line-by-line with the customer. This gives the customer an opportunity to understand the charges recorded for the completed service.

Old parts. Old parts are handed over to the customer unless they are returned to OEM under warranty. The advisor should therefore identify whether the parts fall under the stated warranty exception when completing the handover.

Post-service satisfaction. A post-service satisfaction call is completed within 48 hours. This extends the customer communication beyond the physical delivery of the vehicle.

Repair Cycle Communication

The SOP connects customer communication across the complete service visit. At reception, the customer participates in the walk-around and signs the condition record. During the repair cycle, the job card preserves the complaint, diagnosis, estimate, and contact information. Where additional work crosses the specified cost threshold, approval is obtained before proceeding. At delivery, the invoice and old parts are addressed, followed by the post-service satisfaction call.

This sequence provides a consistent service-reception path from vehicle arrival through post-service follow-up.

Service Advisor Responsibilities

The service advisor is responsible for carrying out the reception, job-card, estimate-approval, and delivery communication steps identified in this SOP. The advisor should keep the relevant records aligned with the stage of the repair cycle and ensure that customer communication occurs at the points specified by the procedure.

Service Reception Quick Reference

SOP-02 establishes the standard process for receiving a customer's vehicle, documenting the service request, obtaining approval for qualifying additional work, and completing delivery communication at Syed Motors.

1. Vehicle Handover

Conduct the walk-around with the customer, record existing dents and scratches on the diagram sheet, check fuel level, mileage, and personal items, and obtain the customer's signature before accepting the vehicle.

2. Job Card

Open the job card in the DMS. Record the customer's complaint in the customer's own words, keep technician diagnosis notes separate, record estimated cost and estimated ready-time, and secure the customer's signature and confirmed contact number.

3. Estimate Approval

When additional work is identified and the additional cost exceeds 10 percent of the estimate, obtain customer approval by call or WhatsApp before proceeding. Record the approval in the job card.

4. Delivery

Walk through the invoice line-by-line, hand over old parts unless returned to OEM under warranty, and complete the post-service satisfaction call within 48 hours.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Service department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner. Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual.

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